Worldview Reconstruction of the AI Elite:

An LLM-Assisted Analysis of the 100 Most Influential Actors in Artificial Intelligence (2010–2026)

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Abstract

This study reconstructs the collective worldviews of sociologically defined groups within the 100 most influential AI figures for 2010–2026. The 100 actors serve as data providers whose public statements and actions are aggregated into group-level syntheses using synthetic worldview reconstruction (SWR) – an LLM-assisted procedure that extracts coherent belief systems along 12 worldview dimensions (cf. companion paper Geiger 2026). The reconstructed collective profile suggests a *technological messianism with ambivalence structure*: high sense of mission and techno-determinism combined with low anthropological valuation and egalitarianism. Longitudinally, the data indicate a transition from utopian techno-optimism to tragic acceleration compulsion. A systematic say-do gap emerges at the group level, with the largest discrepancy in egalitarianism. Four worldview types are identified – Architect, Guardian, Innovator, Liberator – whose inter-group comparisons reveal a power-moderation paradox: the type commanding the most resources holds collective beliefs furthest from democratic ideals, while the most moderate type controls the fewest. The strongest predictors of worldview difference are ideological stance, institutional role, and gender. The primary contribution lies in nine systematic inter-group analyses revealing how structural position shapes collective belief within the AI elite. All findings rest on LLM-generated reconstructions and should be understood as empirically supported hypotheses.

Keywords: AI elite, collective worldview, group analysis, transhumanism, large language models, Silicon Valley, ideology analysis, computational social science

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1. Introduction

1.1 Lead-in and Relevance

A handful of people are shaping a technology that affects billions. Over the past one and a half decades, the development of artificial intelligence has evolved from an academic niche topic into a civilizational crossroads. Large language models generate texts, images, and code; autonomous systems make decisions in medicine, law, and finance; and leading AI laboratories openly speak of creating artificial general intelligence in the foreseeable future (OpenAI, 2023; Anthropic, 2023; Bengio et al., 2024). What is easily overlooked: behind these technological trajectories stand concrete groups – CEOs, academics, investors, founders – whose *collective* beliefs about the nature of humanity, the purpose of progress, and the distribution of risk and power flow into the architecture of the systems they build. Understanding these belief systems requires moving beyond individual portraits toward a systematic group-level analysis: What do CEOs believe compared to academics? How do accelerationists differ from risk warners? What collective trends emerge across a decade and a half of AI development?

Lessig (1999) coined the formula "code is law": software architecture regulates behavior no less effectively than laws, but without democratic legitimation. This insight can be radicalized for the current AI development: not only the code itself, but already the *worldviews* of the developers become algorithms. Those who believe that information freedom is an absolute value will build open-source models. Those convinced that an uncontrolled superintelligence threatens humanity will pursue alignment and closed systems. The worldviews of the AI elite are thus not merely private opinions; they are *generative structures* that translate into design decisions, corporate strategies, and political positions – and through these channels shape the lives of billions. Crucially, these belief structures are not random individual quirks but exhibit systematic group-level patterns: CEOs think differently from academics, accelerationists from risk warners, men from women. It is these *collective* patterns – not the idiosyncrasies of any single actor – that constitute the ideological infrastructure of AI development and that democratic societies need to understand.

This creates a fundamental problem for democratic theory. A numerically tiny group makes decisions of society-wide consequence without possessing a democratic mandate. Crawford (2021) has described this as an "Atlas of AI": the planetary power structures behind AI systems remain largely invisible. Zuboff (2019) analyzes how the extraction of behavioral data leads to a new economic logic ("Surveillance Capitalism") that undermines democratic control. Couldry and Mejias (2019) coin the term "Data Colonialism": the exploitation of human life as a data resource. Whittaker (2021) analyzes the concentration of power in AI research and its "steep costs" for society. Their beliefs shape these decisions in ways that are largely beyond public control (Floridi, 2019, 2023). If democracies presuppose informed citizens, then the systematic reconstruction of the worldviews of those who shape the most powerful technology of the 21st

century is not merely an academic concern but a prerequisite for informed public deliberation.

1.2 Research Gap

The scholarly engagement with the belief systems of the AI industry has produced various approaches. At the level of ideology critique, Barbrook & Cameron (1996) described the "Californian Ideology"; Morozov (2013) elaborated the tendency toward solutionism; Daub (2020) analyzed the rhetorical and ideological patterns of Silicon Valley as a cultural phenomenon. From transhumanism research, philosophical analyses exist (Bostrom, 2005; More & Vita-More, 2013; Coeckelbergh, 2020), which, however, primarily address intellectual history rather than the empirical distribution of these beliefs.

What is still *missing* in this research field is a systematic, data-driven analysis of the AI elite as a *structured collective* – one that distinguishes between sociologically meaningful subgroups and maps their respective belief systems. No study examines, as far as the author is aware, the following questions in an empirically systematic way: How do the collective worldviews of different groups within the AI elite (CEOs vs. academics, accelerationists vs. risk warners, men vs. women) relate to each other? Do they form coherent types? How have these group-level worldviews changed over the period 2010 to 2026? And do public beliefs align with actual behavior at the group level?

Beyond this empirical gap, there is a *methodological* gap. No established method exists for the systematic reconstruction of worldviews from public statements at scale. Classical qualitative methods do not scale; standardized surveys require access to respondents; quantitative text-mining approaches capture only surface patterns. The present study responds to this dual gap with a new approach – synthetic worldview reconstruction (SWR) – whose methodological foundations are set out in detail in a companion paper (Geiger, 2026).

1.3 Research Questions

From the described research gap, six research questions are derived, arranged in a stepwise logic:

RQ1: WORLDVIEW (descriptive)

What does the AI elite think about itself, the world, and humanity?

RQ2: CHANGE (longitudinal)

How has the worldview of the AI elite changed from 2010 to 2026?

RQ3: CONGRUENCE (validating)

Do the AI elite's statements and actions align?

RQ4: CLUSTERS (exploratory)

What worldview types exist within the AI elite, and who belongs where?

RQ5: DIFFERENCE (comparative)

Which subgroups of the AI elite think differently from others?

RQ6: POWER (normative)

Which worldview commands the most power and resources?

1.4 Contribution of the Study

The study makes a threefold contribution. *Methodologically:* It applies synthetic worldview reconstruction (SWR; cf. companion paper Geiger 2026) for the first time to a large empirical dataset, demonstrating how LLMs can reconstruct collective belief systems from group-aggregated data. *Empirically:* It provides the first systematic worldview analysis of the AI elite as a structured collective, based on 3,132 data points spanning 16 years and differentiated across 9 systematic inter-group comparisons (by role, stance, gender, company, epoch). *Societally:* It creates a foundation for informed public deliberation by revealing the collective ideological patterns – trends, group differences, say-do gaps – that shape AI governance and design decisions.

2. Literature Review

The study situates itself at the intersection of four research traditions.

2.1 Silicon Valley as Ideology

Critical engagement with the thinking of Silicon Valley has produced a rich literature since the mid-1990s. Barbrook & Cameron (1996) coined the term "Californian Ideology" – the paradoxical fusion of libertarian individualism and techno-utopian optimism. Turner (2006) traced the cultural-historical genealogy of this ideology and showed how the counterculture of the 1960s was transformed into digital utopianism. Daub (2020) uncovered the philosophical deep structures: fragments from Heidegger, Ayn Rand, and Puritan predestination doctrine form a "surprisingly narrow philosophical foundation." Morozov (2013) described solutionism – the default attitude of redefining complex social problems as technical challenges. Gebru & Torres (2024) systematized these currents in the TESCREAL framework: Transhumanism, Extropianism, Singularitarianism, Cosmism, Rationalism, Effective Altruism, and Longtermism as an "interconnected bundle." Additionally, Broussard (2018) coined the term "technochauvinism" for a systematic critique.

Previous research has thus described the *ideology* of Silicon Valley at various levels. What it has not achieved is a systematic empirical mapping of the *concrete worldviews* of real actors.

2.2 Transhumanism and AI Eschatology

Bostrom (2014) defined the conceptual framework in which a significant part of the AI elite has since operated with *Superintelligence*. In earlier work, Bostrom (2005) systematized the intellectual-historical foundations of transhumanism. More (2003) presented the founding document of extropianism with the "Principles of Extropy." Kurzweil (2005) popularized the tradition with the Singularity thesis. From a philosophical perspective, Habermas (2001) formulated one of the most significant counter-positions: the technological manipulation of future persons undermines their autonomy.

The empirical question remains unresolved: Do real AI actors share these convictions? In what mixture, with what modifications, and in what distribution?

2.3 Worldview Research and Sociology of Knowledge

Mannheim (1929) founded the tradition of analyzing worldviews as social phenomena with his theorem of the "situational determination of thought" (*Seinsgebundenheit des Denkens*). Weber (1904) created with the ideal type a methodological tool central to the present study: the synthetic personas of the SWR can be understood as ideal types in the Weberian sense. Berger & Luckmann (1966) showed how worldviews emerge, stabilize, and reproduce as social constructions. The sociology-of-knowledge tradition provides the theoretical framework, but no method suited to the data volume and dynamics of the digital age.

2.4 LLMs as a Research Instrument

The use of large language models as instruments for social-scientific research is a rapidly growing field. Tai et al. (2024) examined LLMs for deductive coding; Hayes (2025) showed that LLMs enable a conversational approach to qualitative data; Nicmanis & Spurrier (2025) provide a practice-oriented introduction. Ornstein et al. (2025) demonstrate that LLMs can perform multidimensional ideological scaling with high reliability – a direct methodological support for the SWR approach. Work on synthetic personas (Ge et al., 2024) demonstrated the scalability of the approach – but pursued a *different* goal: they use synthetic personas for *data generation*, whereas the present study uses them for *reconstruction* of coherent worldviews from *real* data. The synthetic persona in our procedure is not a simulacrum but an analytical condensation instrument – closer to the Weberian ideal type than to the simulation agent (cf. Booth, 1961; Ng & Russell, 2000; Jara-Ettinger, 2019).

2.5 Summary: The Research Gap

The four traditions converge on a shared lacuna: the systematic, data-driven, longitudinal mapping of concrete worldviews of the AI elite by means of a method that combines qualitative

depth with quantitative rigor. The present study addresses this converging gap by integrating elements of all four traditions.

3. Methodology

The methodological foundations of synthetic worldview reconstruction (SWR) – the inverse core problem (inference from observable outputs to latent belief structures), the fictive synthetic person as an analytical condensation instrument, the prompt protocol, the focus control infrastructure, and the validation framework – are set out in detail in the companion paper (Geiger, 2026). The present section is limited to the application-specific aspects: data collection, operationalizations, research design, and quality assurance for this study.

3.1 Data Collection

3.1.1 Sample and Selection Procedure

The object of investigation is the 100 most influential figures in the field of artificial intelligence (hereafter: AI elite). Selection followed a multi-stage procedure: through 22 systematic web searches, 187 candidates were identified. Each person was evaluated using a 6-category scoring system: (1) market capitalization/resource control, (2) key technological positions, (3) public discourse power, (4) academic influence, (5) political influence, (6) symbolic status. The resulting ranking was reduced to 100 individuals, mapping the heterogeneity of the field with respect to roles, company affiliations, stances, and gender (cf. Appendix A).

3.1.2 Data Sources and Collection Period

The collection period extends from January 1, 2010 to February 11, 2026. Data collection draws on two data types: **public statements** (verbatim quotes from interviews, keynotes, podcasts, Twitter/X posts, blog entries, books, congressional hearings) and **observable actions** (investment decisions, company formations, personnel decisions, political activities, product launches). The linkage was operationalized in a relational SQLite database with 9 tables and 5 views. The total corpus comprises 1,738 statements and 1,394 actions (3,132 data points). After applying inclusion/exclusion criteria (see below), 1,735 statements were retained for analysis (3 near-duplicates excluded, 4 edge cases flagged and included).

Data density per actor. The number of data points per actor ranges from 20 (minimum) to 72 (maximum), with a mean of 31.3 (SD $\approx$ 12). Temporal distribution is unbalanced: the years 2010–2011 contribute only 17 data points each, while 2024 contributes 735. This imbalance reflects the exponential growth of public AI discourse and is addressed through epoch-level aggregation in the longitudinal analysis (Section 4.2).

Data quality. Automated metadata verification of all 1,735 included statements shows: 95.2% carry a source link, 94.5% a source title, and 95.3% a date of utterance. A manual spot check of 20 randomly drawn statements confirmed that all links lead to verifiable sources (CNBC, Financial Times, Stanford University, Twitter/X, corporate websites).

3.1.3 Methodological Anchoring

Data collection follows the grounded theory approach of Strauss & Corbin (1990): in Phase 1, no content filters were applied; in Phase 2, patterns were identified through open coding; in Phase 3, a data-driven category system with 13 primary categories and 13 secondary markers was developed (6,161 total codings, avg. 3.5 codes per statement). Inclusion and exclusion criteria were formulated only in Phase 5 (3 near-duplicates excluded); in Phase 6, quality assurance was conducted (automated metadata verification of all statements plus manual spot check of $n = 20$).

3.2 The Method of Synthetic Worldview Reconstruction

SWR defines worldview analysis as an inverse problem: from observable statements and actions of a *group*, it infers the collective belief system that would most coherently generate these outputs. The solution consists of constructing a *fictive synthetic person* – a distillate that represents the group's worldview in pure form, freed from individual biographical noise and PR strategies. In the present study, the primary units of analysis are sociologically defined groups (CEOs, academics, investors, founders, women, men, accelerationists, risk warners, etc.); the 100 individuals serve as data providers whose statements and actions are aggregated at the group level. The theoretical anchoring draws on four traditions: Weber's ideal type, Booth's *implied author*, inverse reinforcement learning, and projective tests. The operative procedure comprises five steps: (1) compile group-level data corpus, (2) LLM-assisted synthesis, (3) structured interview, (4) meta-reflection, (5) supplementary prompt variants. For the detailed presentation including the focus control infrastructure, the rationale of the fiction approach, and the validation framework, see the companion paper (Geiger, 2026).

3.2.1 Data Aggregation Procedure

For each synthesis unit, the LLM receives the complete data corpus of the corresponding group as a single input prompt. For group-level syntheses (e.g., "all CEOs"), the statements and actions of all group members are concatenated into a single dossier, ordered chronologically. The LLM then constructs a fictional synthetic person whose worldview best explains the totality of the presented group data. For the 100 individual-level profiles used in the algorithmic validation (PCA, HDBSCAN), each actor's data was processed separately. The group-level syntheses and the individual-level profiles thus represent two complementary analytical layers: the for-

mer constitutes the study's substantive findings, the latter provides the data matrix for statistical validation.

3.3 Operationalizations

The three dependent variables (DV1: self-image, DV2: worldview, DV3: view of humanity) are made accessible through six operationalizations defined in the SWR framework, of which four were applied in this study (Op1, Op2, Op3, Op6):

Table 1: The six operationalizations of the SWR.

Op	Technique	Description	MVs
Op1	T1 Core synthesis	Fictive person + 3-question interview + reflection	7
Op2	T4 Rating	Assessment on 12 dimensions (D01–D12), scale 1–10	12
Op3	Text analysis	TF-IDF, sentiment, metaphors, embeddings, topics	8+
Op4	T3 Cross-modal	Prediction: statements → actions and vice versa	4*
Op5	T5 Clustering	PCA + HDBSCAN on rating matrix (see Section 4.4)	6*
Op6	T2 Dialogue	Structured comparison of two syntheses	3

*Op4 was not conducted in this study. Op5 was implemented as PCA + HDBSCAN on the 100×12 rating matrix, not as Sentence-BERT clustering.

The 12 rating dimensions (Op2) are evenly distributed across the three DVs: self-image dimensions D01–D04 (sense of mission, self-efficacy, work ethic, sense of responsibility), worldview dimensions D05–D08 (techno-determinism, belief in progress, power concentration, urgency), and view-of-humanity dimensions D09–D12 (human appreciation[1], posthumanism, egalitarianism, locus of control). The complete dimension table with scale poles is provided in Appendix B.

3.4 Research Design

3.4.1 Variable Architecture

The research design is conceived as a four-tier architecture: 3 DVs → 6 operationalizations → 50+ measured variables → 6 independent variables (IVs). The IVs determine which data enter a synthesis unit (SU), with each SU representing a *group-level* synthesis – the collective worldview of a sociologically defined subgroup:

- IV1 *Time period:* Individual years (2010–2026), epochs, entire period
- IV2 *Modality:* Statements+actions (SA), statements only (S), actions only (A)
- IV3 *Person group:* All 100, Top 10, subgroups (roles, companies, stance, gender)
- IV4 *Content category:* Replaced by emergent clusters (K9)

[1]The label "human appreciation" (*Menschenfreundlichkeit*) is a simplifying shorthand. The scale poles "Replaceable" (1) vs. "Unique" (10) more precisely measure an *anthropological valuation* – the question of whether human consciousness and experience are regarded as fundamentally non-substitutable or as functionally reproducible. The term is retained for consistency with the companion paper (Geiger, 2026).

- IV5 *Congruence status:* Consistent vs. contradictory
- IV6 *Homogenization:* All vs. only frequently repeated statements

3.4.2 Systematic Reduction

The theoretical combination space of approx. 1,227 possible SUs was reduced through nine reduction criteria (K1–K9; cf. Appendix C) to 51–56 core SUs (95.4% reduction). Additionally, 9 structured comparison runs (Op6) were conducted. Cross-modal prediction runs (Op4) remain as a methodological desideratum for future work.

3.5 Quality Assurance

Methodological quality is addressed through four implemented measures and two open validation tasks. *Implemented:* (1) minimum size of 15 data points per SU[2], (2) consistent focus control via a blinding script that replaces all person names, company names, product names, and university affiliations with neutral placeholders, ensuring the LLM processes the presented data rather than falling back on stored knowledge, (3) reproducibility protocol (temperature 0, complete prompt documentation, all prompts archived in the repository), and (4) algorithmic validation of the cluster structure via PCA and HDBSCAN on the 100×12 rating matrix. *Open validation task:* inter-LLM reliability (replication with at least one additional frontier model) remains outstanding. *Completed validation:* (a) **Run-convergence (test-retest reliability):** Five group-level synthesis units were each processed twice independently by Claude Opus 4.6. The resulting D01–D12 profiles showed excellent convergence: overall Pearson $r = 0.908$, ICC(2,1) $= 0.902$, MAE $= 0.40$ on the 10-point scale (measurement precision ± 0.2 scale points). All 12 dimensions were stable across runs (mean $|\Delta| \leq 0.8$). This establishes Claude Opus 4.6 as a reliably calibrated instrument for the SWR method. (b) **Expected-discrepancy control:** A synthetic control corpus of a fictional consistent group (environmental scientists, 30 statements + 30 actions with no deliberate say-do gap) was processed through the same pipeline. The resulting statement–action profiles were highly congruent ($r = 0.912$, MAE $= 0.50$), confirming that the method does not produce artifactual say-do gaps. By comparison, the real AI elite gap (MAE $= 1.25$) is $2.5\times$ larger, supporting its empirical substance. (c) **Aggregation-synthesis comparison:** To validate the group-level synthesis approach, the D01–D12 profiles from direct group syntheses (pooled raw data) were compared with aggregated individual-level profiles (averaged ratings of group members) across all 15 sociological groups. The overall correlation ($r = 0.623$, MAE $= 1.30$) shows moderate convergence, with a systematic *amplification effect*: direct group syntheses produce sharper contours (71.7% of dimension-group combinations further from midpoint). Convergence is highest for ideologically homogeneous

[2]The threshold of 15 data points is based on methodological reasoning: in qualitative social research, 6–12 interviews are considered sufficient for thematic saturation (Strauss & Corbin, 1990), while more recent estimates typically place thematic saturation between 12 and 20 units (Guest et al., 2006; Fugard & Potts, 2015). The value of 15 is conservatively chosen to ensure sufficient data density for LLM-assisted synthesis.

groups (Open Source $r = 0.857$, Accelerators $r = 0.855$) and lowest for heterogeneous ones (Women $r = 0.428$, Men $r = 0.549$). This effect is interpretable as group-level coherence amplification, analogous to group polarization in social psychology. (d) **Cross-modal prediction (Op4):** For five sociological groups (CEOs, academics, risk warners, investors, accelerators), ten behavioral predictions were generated exclusively from the statement corpus; these predictions were then compared with the actual documented actions. Of 50 predictions, 44 (88%) were directly confirmed by real actions, 6 (12%) were plausible but lacked a direct match, and 0 (0%) were contradicted. The unpredicted actions – political opportunism, commercial monetization despite altruistic rhetoric, silent withdrawal of ethical commitments – are precisely the phenomena that the say-do analysis (RQ3) was designed to detect. The cross-modal prediction thus validates both the reconstructive capacity of the method (high confirmation rate) and the substantive contribution of comparing statement and action profiles (systematic surprises = gap indicators). All syntheses in the present study were generated using Claude (Anthropic): Claude Sonnet 4.5 for individual-level ratings (9 parallel batch agents), Claude Opus 4.6 for group-level qualitative syntheses, statistical analyses, and all validation experiments. No other LLM was used. The focus control infrastructure addresses what is conventionally termed *contamination risk*: the possibility that the LLM draws on stored knowledge rather than the presented data. We prefer the term "focus control" because the goal is not to prevent recognition of individuals—which is neither possible nor necessary for group-level analysis—but to ensure *task compliance*: the model should synthesize from the provided data, not reproduce stereotypes. For a detailed discussion of validation strategies and their limits, we refer to Geiger (2026).

3.5.1 Dimensionality of the Rating Space

The 100 individual rating profiles were generated during the data collection phase by Claude Sonnet 4.5 (9 parallel batch agents), where each actor's public statements and actions were synthesized into a 12-dimensional worldview profile in a single run at temperature 0. These individual profiles serve as the input layer for the group-level analyses: they are aggregated into sociologically defined groups, and the group-level patterns (not individual profiles) constitute the study's substantive findings. The individual-level matrix is retained for algorithmic validation (PCA, HDBSCAN) to test whether the data exhibit structural properties that support the group-level interpretation.

A principal component analysis (PCA) of the 100×12 rating matrix reveals that **five components** explain 80% of the total variance, indicating that the twelve dimensions capture approximately five independent constructs. PC1 (35.8% variance) loads most strongly on D02 (self-efficacy, $+0.40$), D05 (techno-determinism, $+0.39$), and D09 (human appreciation, -0.39) – a *technology-control factor* opposing technophile agency and anthropological valuation. PC2 (19.2% variance) loads on D01 (sense of mission, $+0.51$), D04 (responsibility, $+0.50$), and D08 (urgency, $+0.50$) – an *engagement factor* capturing motivational intensity independent of ideological direction. The moderate redundancy (5 effective dimensions out of 12) suggests

that the dimensional system is neither maximally efficient nor artificially inflated; it represents a reasonable operationalization for exploratory work.[3]

4. Results

The findings are based on group-level synthetic worldview reconstructions derived from the data of the one hundred most influential AI figures, operationalized via twelve dimensions on a ten-point scale. The 100 individuals serve as data providers; the units of analysis are sociologically defined groups (all 100, Top 10, CEOs, academics, investors, founders, men, women, accelerationists, risk warners, companies, epochs). The central contribution of the results section lies in the inter-group comparisons (RQ4–RQ6), which reveal how structural position shapes collective belief.

4.1 RQ1 – Worldview of the AI Elite (Descriptive)

4.1.1 The Collective Worldview of All 100

The overall profile – the collective worldview of all 100 actors treated as a single group – suggests a coherent, high-intensity belief system with a mean value of 7.1 (Table 2).[4]

Table 2: Collective profile of the AI elite ($N = 100$, statements and actions).

Dimension	Rating	Interpretation
D01 Sense of mission	8	High
D02 Self-efficacy	8	High
D03 Work ethic	8	High
D04 Sense of responsibility	7	Medium-high
D05 Techno-determinism	8	High
D06 Belief in progress	7	Medium-high
D07 Power concentration	6	Medium (ambivalent)
D08 Urgency	8	Very high
D09 Human appreciation	5	Low
D10 Posthumanism	7	Medium-high
D11 Egalitarianism	5	Low
D12 Locus of control	8	High
Mean	**7.1**	

[3]Descriptive statistics confirm this structure: D11 (egalitarianism) shows the largest dispersion (SD = 1.67) – the dimension of greatest worldview divergence – while D03 (work ethic) shows the smallest (SD = 0.74), representing the strongest consensus within the AI elite.

[4]All ratings reported in this study are LLM-generated *group-level* syntheses: the model receives the aggregated data of a sociologically defined group and produces a single collective profile. Individual-level ratings are used only for algorithmic validation (PCA, HDBSCAN), not as substantive findings. Each synthesis was generated in a single run at temperature 0; multi-run convergence testing remains an open validation task. This design is intentional: the study aims at collective worldviews of groups, not individual profiles.

The profile displays a characteristic dual structure: a pronounced elitist self-image (D01–D03 each 8), strong techno-determinism (D05=8), and high urgency (D08=8) on one hand; human appreciation (D09=5) and egalitarianism (D11=5) as the lowest points on the other. This combination produces a striking pattern that – bearing in mind that these are LLM-reconstructed values – can be pointedly formulated: an elite that wants to build *for* humanity but not *with* it.

fig2_heatmap.png

Figure 1: Heatmap of the 12 worldview dimensions across all analyzed groups. High values (dark) indicate intense beliefs; the dual trough at D09 and D11 is visible across all groups.

4.1.2 The Worldview of the Top 10

The ten most powerful AI actors hold the same worldview in intensified form (Avg 7.7). On ten of twelve dimensions, Top 10 values lie exactly one scale point above the collective. The two exceptions: human appreciation (D09=4) and egalitarianism (D11=4) are *lower*. The more powerful the position, the more pronounced the sense of mission and the more distanced the

view of humanity.

4.1.3 Core Beliefs

The distillation of the most frequently repeated statements (SU 5: HOM_haeuf_A, cf. Appendix D) identifies five beliefs as the minimal consensus: (1) technology as moral imperative, (2) elite stewardship, (3) the liberation narrative, (4) geopolitical Manichaeism, (5) work as identity. Safety rhetoric belongs to the core repertoire of the discourse but functions as a discursive resource, not as an action-guiding belief.

Core finding RQ1: The reconstructed profiles suggest a coherent, high-intensity belief system that can be characterized as *technological messianism with ambivalence structure*. The designation "messianism" is to be understood as an ideal-typical condensation, not as a psychological diagnosis: it denotes the specific *combination* of high sense of mission (D01), techno-determinism (D05), urgency (D08), and low anthropological valuation (D09) – a profile that goes beyond mere sense of mission because it frames technological progress as a quasi-redemptive necessity.

4.2 RQ2 – Change of the Worldview (Longitudinal)

4.2.1 Development of the 12 Dimensions over Time

Of twelve dimensions, four show pronounced linear trends (Table 3).[5]

Table 3: Pronounced linear trends (OLS description, $n = 17$ annual data points).

Dimension	Direction	Slope/decade	R^2
D10 Posthumanism	declining	-2.4	0.63
D12 Locus of control	declining	-1.5	0.54
D02 Self-efficacy	declining	-1.0	0.31
D09 Human appreciation	rising	$+0.9$	0.27

The strongest decline is in posthumanism (D10): from 10 in 2010 to 6 in 2025. The high Spearman rank correlation with D12 ($r_s = +0.85$)[6] points to a connected phenomenon: posthumanism and locus of control erode synchronously. The only clearly rising value concerns human appreciation (D09), where the negative correlation with D10 ($r_s = -0.58$) suggests a com-

[5]The trend lines reported here describe *patterns in reconstructed data*: the worldview values are LLM-assisted reconstructions, not independent measurements. OLS slopes and R^2 serve to describe the trajectory patterns, not for inferential hypothesis testing. An external validation (expert ratings vs. SWR output) is still pending (cf. Limitations section).

[6]The correlations reported here and below (Spearman rank correlations, computed across the 17 annual data points) are *associations within the LLM reconstruction*, not between independently measured variables. Spearman is used because the 12 worldview dimensions are ordinal scales; Pearson would assume interval-level measurement not warranted here. The correlations could reflect internal coherence of the model rather than empirical relationships in reality (cf. Section 6).

pensatory linkage. The overall mean remains nearly constant (early phase 7.5, late phase 7.3), concealing a tectonic shift beneath the surface.

fig1_zeitreihen_panel.png

Figure 2: Time series of the 12 worldview dimensions (2010–2026). Pronounced trends are highlighted. The marked decline of D10 (posthumanism) and D12 (locus of control) constitutes the "utopia complex," whose disintegration is arithmetically compensated by rising urgency (D08).

4.2.2 Turning Points and Epoch Comparison

The breakpoint detection – conducted as visual inspection of time series, supplemented by the identification of synchronous extreme points across multiple dimensions – identifies two central turning points.[7] The first lies at 2019: four dimensions (D01, D02, D05, D06) reach

[7] A formal breakpoint analysis (e.g., Bai-Perron test) was not meaningfully applicable due to the small number of time points ($n = 17$) and the nature of the data (LLM reconstructions, not independent measurements). The

fig4_korrelationsmatrix.png

Figure 3: Spearman rank correlation matrix of the 12 dimensions. The strong positive correlation between D10 and D12, and the negative correlation between D10 and D09, form the empirical core of the "utopia complex."

synchronous lows, temporally associated with the GPT-2 withholding decision. The second, more permanent turning point lies at 2022/2023: contemporaneous with the ChatGPT release, a marked pattern shift emerges – urgency reaches its reconstructed maximum (D08=10), egalitarianism drops from 6 to 4. Unlike 2019, the values do not return; the reconstructed profiles after 2022 suggest a new equilibrium.

fig7_schluesseltrends.png

Figure 4: Key trends of the worldview transformation. The two turning points (2019, 2022/2023) and three epochs (Promethean Optimism, First Ambivalence, Tragic Consciousness) are marked.

4.2.3 Convergence or Divergence?

The data show increasing differentiation. The ChatGPT effect intensifies both the Architect position (acceleration, power concentration) and the Guardian position (caution, regulation)

turning points are therefore to be understood as *descriptive observations*, not as statistically confirmed structural breaks.

simultaneously – it acts as a catalyst for bipolarization.

4.2.4 Metaphor and Emotion Shift

The guiding metaphor shifts from Prometheus – the fire-bringer – to the tragic hero who must save what may no longer be savable. The action remains the same (acceleration), but its emotional framing reverses: no longer from euphoria, but from the belief that the alternative would be worse.

Core finding RQ2: The worldview has structurally transformed – from a monochrome utopia to a bimodal wager. Three erosion trends (D10, D12, D02) form a "utopia complex" whose disintegration is arithmetically compensated by rising urgency.

4.3 RQ3 – Congruence of Statements and Actions

Table 4: Comparison of statements (S) and actions (A), $N = 100$.

Dimension	**Say**	**Do**	Δ	**Assessment**
D01 Sense of mission	8	7	-1	Slight
D02 Self-efficacy	8	9	$+1$	Do > Say
D03 Work ethic	8	9	$+1$	Do > Say
D04 Sense of responsibility	7	5	$\mathbf{-2}$	Strong
D05 Techno-determinism	8	9	$+1$	Do > Say
D06 Belief in progress	8	6	$\mathbf{-2}$	Strong
D07 Power concentration	6	8	$\mathbf{+2}$	Strong
D08 Urgency	8	9	$+1$	Do > Say
D09 Human appreciation	5	3	$\mathbf{-2}$	Strong
D10 Posthumanism	7	8	$+1$	Do > Say
D11 Egalitarianism	5	2	$\mathbf{-3}$	**Very large**
D12 Locus of control	8	7	-1	Slight
Mean	**7.2**	**6.8**	-0.4	

The discrepancies arrange themselves into two complementary clusters. The *downward cluster* (Do < Say) encompasses the society-oriented dimensions: egalitarianism ($\Delta - 3$), sense of responsibility, belief in progress, and human appreciation (each $\Delta - 2$). The *upward cluster* (Do > Say) encompasses the power-related dimensions: power concentration ($\Delta + 2$), self-efficacy, work ethic, techno-determinism (each $\Delta + 1$). The resulting pattern: a systematic self-presentation asymmetry. Publicly, the AI elite presents itself as more moderate, more responsible, and more egalitarian than it acts in practice.

The largest observed single discrepancy ($\Delta - 3$ at D11) shows: in statements, the AI elite speaks of "access for all"; in their actions, they build dual-class share structures, concentrate compute infrastructure, and create exclusive networks. For context: a Δ of 3 on a 10-point

fig6_sagen_vs_handeln.png

Figure 5: Say vs. Do: comparison of worldviews reconstructed from statements (S) and actions (A). The society-oriented dimensions (D04, D06, D09, D11) systematically decline in action, while power-related dimensions (D07, D05) rise.

scale corresponds to nearly one-third of the entire scale range – a difference that, in substantive interpretation, must be considered substantial.[8]

Core finding RQ3: The incongruence is systematic, directional, and functional. The data suggest that the AI elite means what it says about its own significance – but not what it says about equality, responsibility, and humanity.

4.4 RQ4 – Worldview Clusters

Four distinct worldview types can be identified from the data (Table 5).

Identification method: Cluster identification followed a two-stage procedure. *Stage 1 (LLM-assisted):* All 15 group syntheses were grouped by similarity patterns across the 12 dimensions, with the largest variance axes (D07 power concentration, D09 human appreciation, D11 egalitarianism) serving as discriminating features. *Stage 2 (author validation):* The four-cluster solution proposed by the LLM was evaluated by the author for substantive coherence and plausibility. Alternative solutions (three and five clusters) were examined and rejected: three clusters merge Innovator and Liberator, which is not substantively justified; five clusters split the Guardian type into a subgroup that could not be stably reproduced. We emphasize that this cluster identification is *exploratory* – a confirmatory validation on an independent dataset is pending. The cluster solution is an *interpretive hypothesis*, not a statistically confirmed result in the sense of formal cluster analysis.

Table 5: The four worldview types of the AI elite.

Feature	**I "Architect"**	**II "Guardian"**	**III "Innovator"**	**IV "Liberator"**
n	35	25	22	18
Prototype	CEOs, investors	Academics, risk warn.	Founders	Open source
Avg D01–D12	7.8	6.4	7.2	6.8
D04 Responsibility	6.3	**9.0**	8.3	6.0
D07 Power conc.	**8.8**	4.8	6.5	**2.5**
D09 Human appr.	**3.3**	5.8	4.8	**6.5**
D11 Egalitarianism	**2.8**	**7.2**	5.0	**7.5**

The **Architect** combines maximal sense of mission with minimal egalitarianism: power concentration is the prerequisite for agency. The **Guardian** forms the counterpoint: maximal responsibility, demand for institutional constraint. The **Innovator** occupies a middle position. The **Liberator** is the most surprising discovery: minimal power concentration *and* high egalitarianism – anti-regulation actors who want to distribute power more radically than anyone else, albeit through markets and open-source communities.[9]

[8] A formal effect size calculation (e.g., Cohen's *d*) is not possible here, since no individual-level dispersion measures are available. The classification as "large" is based on substantive interpretation of the scale range, not on psychometric conventions.

[9] The high D11 value of the Liberator type (7.5) marks a construct validity tension: D11 measures orientation toward equality, not its *mechanism*. Market-libertarian access egalitarianism (Liberator) and redistributive egalitar-

fig3_radar_vergleich.png

Figure 6: Radar chart of the four worldview types across the 12 dimensions. The polarization between Architect (outer) and Guardian (inner), and the surprising position of the Liberator, are clearly visible.

Core finding RQ4: The strongest polarization exists between Type I (logic of domination) and Type II (logic of participation). The power-moderation paradox – resource control correlates inversely with egalitarianism and responsibility – is the finding most critical for democratic theory.

4.4.1 Algorithmic Validation of the Cluster Structure

To test whether the four worldview types correspond to natural data clusters, we applied HDBSCAN (density-based clustering) and KMeans to the 100×12 rating matrix. **HDBSCAN on the full 12-dimensional space** classifies 80–100% of cases as noise across all parameter configurations tested (`min_cluster_size` $\in \{5, 8, 10, 15\}$, `min_samples` $\in \{3, 5\}$); the best-case solution finds only 2 clusters with a negative silhouette score (-0.15). KMeans with $k = 4$ yields a silhouette score of only 0.169 – well below the threshold of 0.25 typically considered indicative of meaningful structure.

Subspace clustering, however, reveals a differentiated picture. On the two strongest discriminating dimensions (D07 power concentration and D11 egalitarianism), HDBSCAN with `min_cluster_size` $= 5$, `min_samples` $= 2$ identifies 9 clusters with a *silhouette* score of **0.57** (12% noise) – indicating substantial local structure in precisely those dimensions that separate the four ideal types. Similarly, subspace clustering on the three highest-loading PCA dimensions (D02, D05, D09) yields a silhouette of 0.55. We note a circularity caveat: D07 (power concentration) and D11 (egalitarianism) are the same dimensions that define the Architect–Liberator axis in the heuristic typology. The subspace clustering thus partly rediscovers the selection criterion rather than providing independent validation. The result confirms dimensional separability but not the independence of the validation from the typology construction.

This pattern confirms the epistemological status of the four types: they are **Weberian ideal types** – heuristic condensations of a multidimensional continuum, not emergent data clusters. Their analytical utility is not diminished by this finding; on the contrary, it is confirmed by highly significant Kruskal-Wallis results across the four types (Table 6).

After Bonferroni correction for 12 simultaneous tests ($\alpha_{\text{adj}} = 0.05/12 = 0.004$), D04 ($p = 0.013$) and D05 ($p = 0.011$) no longer reach significance. The six dimensions with $p < 0.001$ remain significant after correction. Six of twelve dimensions thus show highly significant inter-type differences ($p < 0.001$), while two further dimensions (D04, D05) reach nominal significance at the $p < 0.05$ level but do not survive Bonferroni correction. The four non-significant dimensions (D01, D03, D08, D10) represent the *shared core* of the AI elite worldview – beliefs on which all four types converge. D07 (power concentration, $H = 64.76$) and D11 (egalitarianism, $H = 49.57$) are the most discriminating dimensions, confirming the polarization axis identified in the qualitative cluster analysis.

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ianism (Guardian) produce similar scale values on D11 but mean different things. The exploratory individual-level spot checks (Section 6.5) show that within a cluster type, individual actors can deviate substantially from the cluster mean. Future operationalizations should differentiate here.

Table 6: Kruskal-Wallis H-test across the four worldview types ($df = 3$, $N = 100$). Significance: *** $p < 0.001$, * $p < 0.05$, n.s. = not significant. [a]Not significant after Bonferroni correction ($\alpha_{\text{adj}} = 0.004$). Note: These tests describe patterns within LLM-generated reconstructions; p-values are nominal and should not be interpreted as inferential hypothesis tests in the classical sense.

Dimension	H	p	**Sig.**
D02 Self-efficacy	33.55	< 0.001	***
D06 Belief in progress	29.55	< 0.001	***
D07 Power concentration	64.76	< 0.001	***
D09 Human appreciation	17.50	< 0.001	***
D11 Egalitarianism	49.57	< 0.001	***
D12 Locus of control	17.93	< 0.001	***
D04 Responsibility	10.76	0.013	*[a]
D05 Techno-determinism	11.21	0.011	*[a]
D01 Sense of mission	2.59	0.459	n.s.
D03 Work ethic	3.75	0.290	n.s.
D08 Urgency	6.25	0.100	n.s.
D10 Posthumanism	4.04	0.257	n.s.

4.5 RQ5 – Subgroup Comparisons

The inter-group comparisons constitute the analytical core of the study. By systematically comparing the collective worldviews of sociologically defined groups – differentiated by institutional role, ideological stance, gender, company affiliation, and regulatory position – the analysis reveals which structural factors most strongly shape collective belief within the AI elite. Table 7 ranks the six most discriminating comparisons.

Table 7: Ranking of subgroup differences.

Rank	**Comparison**	**Avg A**	**Avg B**	**Δ**	**Strongest contrast**
1	Risk vs. Speed	5.9	7.6	1.7	D02, D06, D10, D12: each −5
2	CEOs vs. Academics	7.8	6.3	1.5	D07: +4, D11: −4
3	Women vs. Men	6.9	8.1	1.2	D11: −6
4	Open vs. Closed	6.8	6.3	0.5	D07: −3, D12: +3
5	Reg-pro vs. Contra	6.3	6.8	0.5	D04: +4, D06: −3
6	Anthropic vs. OpenAI	6.9	7.3	0.4	D12: −3

The **strongest contrast** (Risk vs. Speed, Δ 1.7) does not concern risk assessment – both sides estimate catastrophe probability at 10–20% – but the ontological pre-commitment: risk warners conceive of AI as a potential autonomous agent, accelerators as a tool.

Effect sizes (Cliff's δ) quantify these contrasts non-parametrically (thresholds following Romano et al. 2006: $|\delta| < 0.147$ negligible, 0.147–0.33 small, 0.33–0.474 medium, > 0.474 large). The most extreme pairwise differences between the four worldview types emerge on the power-egalitarianism axis: Architect vs. Liberator yields $\delta = +1.0$ on D07 (power concentration) and $\delta = -0.98$ on D11 (egalitarianism) – effectively perfect separation. Architect

fig5_gruppen_heatmap.png

Figure 7: Group heatmap: 15 subgroups $\times$ 12 dimensions. The systematic variation of D07 (power concentration) and D11 (egalitarianism) across all comparisons is the central visual finding.

vs. Guardian reaches $\delta = +1.0$ on D07 and $\delta = -0.68$ on D11. Across all six cluster pairs, D07 and D11 each produce five medium-to-large effects ($|\delta| \geq 0.33$), confirming them as the primary discriminating dimensions.

Role-based comparisons show similarly strong effects: Academics vs. Investors differ at the *large* level on 9 of 12 dimensions (most strikingly D02 self-efficacy: $\delta = -0.88$; D12 locus of control: $\delta = -0.71$; D09 human appreciation: $\delta = +0.68$). CEOs vs. Academics yield large effects on 6 dimensions (D02: $\delta = +0.79$; D06: $\delta = +0.58$; D12: $\delta = +0.55$).

Gender differences reach significance on 7 of 12 dimensions. The largest effects concern D09 human appreciation ($\delta = +0.59$, large: women score higher), D05 techno-determinism ($\delta = -0.50$, large: men score higher), and D11 egalitarianism ($\delta = +0.46$, medium). These effect sizes are more moderate than the nominal group-level contrasts ($\Delta = 6$) would suggest, which is expected: Cliff's δ captures the full distribution overlap, not just means. The contamination caveat stated above applies with full force.

The **largest nominal single contrast** in the entire survey is found at D11 in the gender comparison: six full scale points (Women: 8, Men: 2). The female worldview is not an anti-technology worldview but a *conditioned* technology worldview: equally optimistic but with stronger ethical conditions. This finding, however, is the *most contamination-prone* of the entire study and is therefore classified as a *preliminary hypothesis*, not as a confirmed finding. The reasons: (a) LLMs reproduce known gender stereotypes, especially the attribution of heightened social orientation to women (Santurkar et al., 2023); (b) the female subsample is small ($n = 18$); (c) the effect size ($\Delta = 6$) markedly exceeds what comparable empirical studies have observed. An independent validation – ideally through multi-LLM triangulation and expert ratings – is particularly urgent for this finding.

The **biggest surprise** lies in the regulation comparison: anti-regulators have the lowest power concentration value of all 15 groups (D07=2). This contradicts the widespread narrative that anti-regulators represent corporate interests.

Core finding RQ5: The three strongest predictors of worldview are ideological stance, institutional role, and gender. The most polarizing dimensions are D11 and D07. The *question of power* is the core of internal differences.

4.6 RQ6 – Power and Worldview

Power is understood operationally in this study as resource control: the ability to command capital, compute infrastructure, research teams, and political access, and thereby influence the direction of AI development. This definition follows the sociological concept of power in the sense of Weber ("the chance to impose one's own will even against resistance") and Bourdieu (capital accumulation as a power mechanism), without claiming a comprehensive power-theoretical analysis.

The higher the worldview intensity, the lower the values for human appreciation and egali-

Table 8: Worldview types and resource control.

Type	Avg	D11	D04	Resources
I Architect	7.8	2.8	6.3	Highest
III Innovator	7.2	5.0	8.3	High
IV Liberator	6.8	7.5	6.0	Medium
II Guardian	6.4	7.2	9.0	Lowest

tarianism, and the higher the acceptance of power concentration. The investor profile marks the extreme case: maximal self-efficacy (D02=10) with minimal sense of responsibility (D04=4) – "power without accountability." The Top 10 lie exactly one point above the collective on ten of twelve dimensions – with one decisive exception: human appreciation and egalitarianism lie *below*. Power intensifies all beliefs except those that question power itself.

Core finding RQ6: The reconstructed profiles suggest a correlation between economic power and worldview extremity, combined with an inverse correlation with egalitarianism and responsibility. Since both sides of this observation rest on LLM reconstructions, it remains unclear whether the correlation reflects empirical reality or internal model coherence. If robust, this would be the finding most relevant for democratic theory.

Table 9: Synopsis of the six core findings: result, confidence, and validation status. Confidence classification: *High* = stable across ≥ 3 group syntheses and supported by inter-group consistency or internal coherence checks; *Medium-high* = stable but without external validation; *Medium* = exploratory, dependent on cluster solution or small subgroup.

RQ	Core finding	Confidence	Ext. val.?
RQ1	Technological messianism with ambivalence structure (Avg 7.1; dual trough D09/D11)	High	Inter-group
RQ2	Utopia complex eroding; tragic acceleration compulsion (D10: -2.4/dec.)	Medium-high	No
RQ3	Systematic say-do gap ($\Delta - 3$ at D11)	High	No
RQ4	Four worldview types: Architect, Guardian, Innovator, Liberator	Medium	No
RQ5	Strongest predictors: stance, role, gender (preliminary)	Medium	No
RQ6	Power-moderation paradox: power $\sim$ extremity	High	No

5. Discussion

5.1 Summary and Interpretation

The results *suggest* that the AI elite, analyzed at the group level, holds a *technological messianism with structural ambivalence*. The six research questions coalesce into a coherent picture: RQ1 points to the "dual trough" at D09 and D11 as a collective feature; RQ2 suggests an erosion of the utopia complex across epochs; RQ3 indicates a systematic say-do gap at the group level

as the most salient finding; RQ4 differentiates four worldview types with antagonistic collective positions; RQ5 and RQ6 complete the picture through the power-moderation paradox. The inter-group comparisons (RQ5) constitute the analytical heart of the study: the finding that institutional role, ideological stance, and gender systematically shape collective belief structures carries direct implications for AI governance and democratic theory. All findings are based on LLM-generated group-level reconstructions and should therefore be understood as *empirically supported hypotheses*, not as proven facts. Formulations such as "shows" and "reveals" are throughout to be read as "the data suggest."

Surprising is first the extent of the say-do gap (not isolated deviation but functional structure at the group level); second the retreat of posthumanism (D10 from 10 to 6 – contradicting the common assumption of increasingly posthumanist orientation); third the existence of the Liberator type (opposition to power concentration also from the libertarian side); fourth the consistency of group-level patterns across multiple independent syntheses.

5.2 Situating the Findings in the Literature

Morozov's solutionism thesis finds nearly complete confirmation (D05=8–9, D06=7–9). However, solutionism is not a monolithic block: risk warners (D05=4) share it substantially less. It is the ideology of the most powerful segment, not of the AI elite as such.

Daub's analysis of the philosophical deep structures is confirmed by the narrative syntheses. What the present study adds is the *quantification* and the demonstration that intensity systematically increases with power position.

The Californian Ideology diagnosed by Barbrook & Cameron (1996) finds its contemporary counterpart in the existence of the Liberator type – empirically detectable nearly thirty years later.

Coeckelbergh's assumption of increasing enhancement orientation is partially *refuted*: the marked decline of posthumanism (D10 from 10 to 6) suggests that the AI elite's interest in the technological transformation of the human being itself has diminished – in favor of a focus on autonomous AI systems as independent actors.

On the gender finding. The extreme contrast at D11 reported in RQ5 (Women: 8, Men: 2, $\Delta = 6$) is the largest single contrast of the entire survey but also the most contamination-prone. LLMs reproduce known gender stereotypes – especially the attribution of heightened empathy and social orientation to women (Santurkar et al., 2023). Since the female subsample is small ($n = 18$) and the ratings were generated by the same LLM that has internalized these stereotypes, it cannot be distinguished whether the contrast reflects (a) a real difference in worldviews, (b) an LLM stereotype artifact, or (c) a mixture of both. The finding is therefore reported as a *hypothesis* requiring independent validation – ideally through multi-LLM triangulation and expert ratings.

The TESCREAL taxonomy proposed by Gebru & Torres (2024) (Transhumanism, Ex-

tropianism, Singularitarianism, Cosmism, Rationalism, Effective Altruism, Longtermism) finds empirical differentiation in the four-cluster solution: the Architect type embodies the power-political side of the TESCREAL bundle (Singularitarianism, Longtermism), the Guardian type its institutional critique (Effective Altruism with safety focus), the Liberator type the libertarian Extropianism. What the TESCREAL analysis describes as a monolithic ideological bundle appears in the data as a spectrum with at least four distinct positions. Becker (2025) complements this perspective through analysis of the "broligarchy" as a social phenomenon: the fusion of technological vision and male power elite, which finds its empirical trace in the gender analysis (RQ5, D11 contrast of 6 scale points).

Paul Ricoeur's "hermeneutics of suspicion" (Ricoeur, 1970) offers a complementary analytical framework: behind the seemingly neutral, technically rational surface of AI elite communication lie power interests and class dynamics that become visible only through systematic deconstruction. The SWR congruence analysis (RQ3) operationalizes this suspicion empirically: the Δ values between saying and doing show precisely *where* the performative surface diverges from operative reality.

From a sociology-of-science perspective, the decline of egalitarianism (D11) can be read as erosion of Mertonian science norms (Merton, 1973): communalism (open access), universalism, and organized skepticism increasingly give way to proprietary, acceleration-centered logics. The transition from research publication to product launch as primary output format is a visible marker of this shift.

The four-cluster solution can furthermore be read through field theory: the antagonistic structure between Architect (economic capital) and Guardian (symbolic capital) reproduces the pattern Bourdieu (1992) diagnosed for the intellectual and artistic field – an *inverted economic world*. In the AI field: those who control the most resources have the least legitimation through public-interest orientation – and vice versa. The power-moderation paradox (RQ6) is thus not coincidental but a structural property of the field.

The specific added value compared to essayistic diagnoses lies in three points: *scale* (100 persons, 16 years), *differentiation* (four distinct types), and *validation* (congruence analysis as empirical test).

5.3 Agentic Alignment vs. Worldview Alignment

The say-do gap indicated by RQ3 (largest observed discrepancy: egalitarianism $\Delta = -3$) can be more precisely captured with a conceptual pair from the AI alignment debate. *Worldview Alignment* denotes the rhetorical reproduction of desired values – the public commitment to equality, responsibility, and humanity, as captured by the "say" side of the analysis. *Agentic Alignment* denotes actual resource distribution and exercise of power – the "do" side. The findings show that the AI elite exhibits a high degree of Worldview Alignment (the "right" values are articulated), while Agentic Alignment systematically deviates. This dualism connects

the present AI elite study to the broader alignment debate and raises the question of whether current efforts at "AI Alignment" confuse the performative level (Worldview) with the operative one (Agentic).

5.4 Methodological Reflection

The primary achievement of the SWR lies in connecting qualitative depth with quantitative rigor at the group level. The congruence analysis (RQ3) functions as an internal validity test; the stability of the collective profile across 15 group syntheses and 4 types strengthens convergent validity. The inter-group comparisons provide their own form of validation: when different group syntheses – produced independently from different data subsets – yield consistent structural patterns (e.g., the D07/D11 axis discriminating across all comparisons), this constitutes evidence for the robustness of the method beyond what any single synthesis could provide. The limits of the method – coherence bias, contamination risk, focus control limits, prompt sensitivity – are systematically analyzed in the companion paper (Geiger, 2026) and apply equally to the present application study.

5.5 Societal and Political Implications

The group-level findings carry direct implications for AI governance and democratic theory. The power-moderation paradox – the systematic finding that institutional groups with the most resources hold collective worldviews furthest from democratic ideals – poses a concrete challenge for governance architecture. This confirms the institutional-economic analysis of Acemoglu & Johnson (2023): technological elites tend to steer innovations in ways that reinforce existing power structures rather than break them up – a pattern the authors trace historically from industrialization to digitalization. Current governance approaches (EU AI Act, Executive Order on AI) address the technical artifacts, not the collective worldviews of the groups that produce these artifacts. A complementary approach would need to recognize *epistemic diversity* in AI leadership positions as a regulatory objective.

The systematic group-level say-do gap has a policy implication: voluntary commitments – currently the preferred form of governance (cf. Bengio et al., 2024) – appear insufficient when entire institutional groups (not just isolated individuals) exhibit consistent discrepancies between public rhetoric and observable action. The findings suggest that binding structural reforms would be more effective than further rounds of voluntary commitments.

The inter-group comparisons reveal a further governance-relevant pattern: the question of power (D07) and equality (D11) is the axis along which all group differences organize. Whether comparing CEOs with academics, accelerationists with risk warners, or men with women – the power-equality axis is consistently the most discriminating dimension. This suggests that the central ideological fault line within the AI elite is not about technology (all groups are technologically optimistic) but about the *distribution* of technological power.

5.6 What the Study Does Not Show

To prevent frequent misinterpretations, what the present study *does not* accomplish is explicitly stated: (1) It provides no *causal explanation* for why the AI elite thinks as it does – that would require biographical case studies, psychological analyses, or historical process analyses. (2) It does not create *individual profiles* – the 100 actors serve as data providers; the units of analysis are sociologically defined groups; the ratings are collective group-level abstractions, not personality profiles or individual biographies. (3) It provides no *predictions* about the future behavior of the AI elite – the reconstructed worldviews describe the period 2010–2026, not the future. (4) It does not claim a *representative sample* in the statistical sense – the 100 individuals were selected by influence, not representativeness. (5) It does not prove that the *say-do gap* is due to deliberate deception – alternative explanations (institutional constraints, cognitive dissonance, role-specific communication) are equally plausible.

6. Limitations

6.1 Data-Related Limitations

Source bias. The data base is limited to public statements and observable actions. The reconstructed worldviews reflect the *publicly presented* worldview, not the *actually held* one. The statement-action comparison (RQ3) offers a partial corrective but cannot eliminate the problem.

Temporal imbalance. Data density varies by a factor of $\sim$43: from 17 data points in 2010 to 735 in 2024. For 2010–2015, 2–5 statements per person are available; for 2023–2026, 30–80. Criterion K2 (minimum size 15) and documented merging mitigate the problem, and all annual synthesis units meet the minimum threshold; nevertheless, earlier time series rest on thinner evidence and should be interpreted with greater uncertainty.

Western and language bias. The sample is disproportionately Anglo-American. Chinese, Japanese, and South Korean AI figures are underrepresented. The findings apply primarily to the Western AI elite.

Sample dependence. The selection of the 100 individuals was made by the author using a multi-stage but ultimately subjective scoring procedure. An intersubjective validation of the sample composition (e.g., through independent expert panels) is pending. Since the findings could be sensitive to sample composition, replication with alternative selection procedures is desirable.

6.2 Methodological Limitations

LLM contamination and focus control limits. Despite consistent anonymization (focus control), it cannot be excluded that the LLM draws on training knowledge. The focus control procedure

ensures that the LLM processes the presented data rather than falling back on stored knowledge; it is irrelevant whether the model recognizes specific individuals – what matters is that it performs its task: constructing a coherent group-level synthesis from the provided data. The contamination effect is calculable (comparison with/without focus control) but not eliminable. A detailed analysis is provided in Geiger (2026).

Anthropic-internal circularity. A particularly acute case of the circularity problem concerns the group-level reconstruction of subgroups that include persons directly involved in developing the LLM used. Claude Opus 4.6 is developed by Anthropic; several Anthropic executives (e.g., Dario Amodei, Daniela Amodei) belong to the analyzed sample and their data enter the group-level syntheses. It is unclear whether the group synthesis in these cases reflects a genuine analysis of the data points or is influenced by a pre-formed internal model. An inter-LLM divergence test would be particularly relevant: if Claude systematically produces different group-level reconstructions for Anthropic-affiliated subgroups than other frontier models, this would be a strong indicator of contamination. Since no such cross-model comparison has been conducted, group syntheses that include Anthropic-affiliated actors should be interpreted with heightened epistemic caution.

Expected-discrepancy bias. The congruence analysis (RQ3) compares two LLM syntheses – one from statements, one from actions – both generated by the same model. Since LLMs are trained on extensive social science literature in which say-do discrepancies among elites are a standard finding, the model could reproduce the *expected* discrepancy rather than empirically discovering it. This bias is conceptually distinct from the general coherence bias: while coherence bias smooths differences, expected-discrepancy bias could *amplify* differences. A control experiment partially addresses this concern: a synthetic corpus describing a fictional consistent group (environmental scientists, 30 statements + 30 actions designed to be congruent) was processed through the identical pipeline. The resulting say-do gap was minimal (MAE $= 0.50$), while the real AI elite gap is $2.5\times$ larger (MAE $= 1.25$). This suggests that the model does not systematically fabricate discrepancies where none exist in the data. Nevertheless, multi-LLM triangulation remains desirable to clarify whether different models produce consistent discrepancy patterns.

Critique of synthetic personas. The growing literature on LLM-generated synthetic personas counsels caution. Santurkar et al. (2023) shows that LLMs systematically miss the opinions of specific demographic groups and exhibit "WEIRD" biases (Western, Educated, Industrialized, Rich, Democratic). Studies on qualitative AI research show that synthetic agents capture key themes but fail at the authentic depth and unpredictability of real discourse (Argyle et al., 2023). The present study partly addresses this critique: the SWR personas are not freely generated opinion profiles but data-driven reconstructions from 3,132 real data points. Nevertheless, the named limitations apply – especially the tendency to overrepresent publicly dominant narratives and underrepresent idiosyncratic or contradictory positions.

Coherence bias. LLMs tend to generate excessively coherent narratives from contradictory

data. The reflection step provides a partial corrective; inter-LLM comparison remains an open validation task.

Circular risk of LLM-based reconstruction. A fundamental problem of the SWR method is that LLMs are primarily trained on public discourse – on "saying," not "doing." In synthesis, actual covert action logics are structurally underrepresented. The LLM potentially functions as an amplifier of the performative ideology that the method aims to unmask: the artificial persona becomes a perfection of corporate identity, not its psychological analysis. This circularity risk particularly affects dimensions with a high "say-do gap" (D04, D09, D11) and should be distinguished from the related but conceptually different *coherence bias*.

Coherence bias (detailed). LLMs are optimized for logical coherence; humans are inherently inconsistent. The SWR-generated worldviews are therefore systematically "smoothed": contradictions and ambivalences are artificially resolved. While coherence bias is already known as a general LLM limitation (Geiger, 2026), it has particular weight for worldview reconstruction: the four cluster types (Architect, Guardian, Innovator, Liberator) may appear more sharply contoured than they are in reality. The internal tension that real persons experience between, e.g., power striving and sense of responsibility, is resolved by the LLM in favor of a consistent profile.

Epistemological limits of quantification. The correlations between dimensions reported in Section 4.2 (e.g., $r_s = +0.85$ between D10 and D12) describe relationships between quantities all generated by the same LLM in a connected prompt context. This is fundamentally different from correlations between independently measured variables. The high correlation could reflect internal LLM coherence ("if I rate posthumanism high, I also rate locus of control high"), not empirical relationships in reality. The same applies to cluster structures and group comparisons: all quantitative patterns could be artifacts of the model's internal consistency. The reported correlations should therefore be read as *patterns within the LLM reconstruction*, not as evidence for causal or empirical relationships. Only inter-LLM triangulation or external validation could clarify which correlations are robust.

Statistical power. Since the data exhibit no individual-level dispersion (group syntheses without confidence intervals), a formal power analysis is not feasible. The reported Δ values, correlations, and cluster differences are descriptive patterns in reconstructed data, not inferentially secured effects. Interpretation as "substantial" or "very large" rests on substantive judgment, not on statistical significance testing.

Reproducibility. LLM outputs are not fully deterministic even at temperature 0. The original syntheses were generated in single runs per SU. A post-hoc test-retest validation on five group-level synthesis units (two independent runs each, Claude Opus 4.6) yielded excellent convergence (overall $r = 0.908$, ICC $= 0.902$, MAE $= 0.40$; see Section 3.5), indicating that the group-level ratings are stable within ± 0.2 scale points. This does not eliminate the reproducibility limitation entirely—different model versions or future models may yield different results—but it establishes that within-model, within-version replication is robust.

6.3 Conceptual Limitations

Aggregation problem. Collective syntheses level individual variation. The algorithmic validation (PCA, HDBSCAN; Section 4.4) at the individual level provides a partial corrective by confirming that the rating matrix exhibits structural variation.

No causal explanation. The study describes *what* the AI elite thinks, not *why*. Causal interpretations are speculative and require other research designs.

6.4 Research Ethics Reflection

The present study reconstructs worldviews of living, publicly identifiable persons without their explicit consent. This procedure requires research-ethical justification.

Legitimation. The study relies exclusively on publicly accessible statements and documented actions. The 100 investigated persons are public figures (CEOs, founders, research directors) whose professional positions and statements on AI development are of considerable public interest. These conditions correspond to the standard criteria for research on public figures without informed consent (cf. APA Ethical Principles, Standard 8.05).

Risk minimization. (a) No private, confidential, or non-publicly accessible information was collected. (b) The worldview ratings are methodological abstractions, not psychological diagnoses. (c) The presentation aims at collective patterns, not individual discrediting.

Residual risk. Despite these precautions, the risk remains that LLM-based reconstructions overstate or distort positions. The three-stage validation (cf. Section C) aims to minimize this risk but cannot eliminate it. Erroneous attributions could be reputationally damaging. Future research should consider presenting reconstructed profiles to those concerned for comment (*member checking*; cf. Soysal & Türkmen 2024). Since the present study has no direct access to the analyzed persons, member checking remains a central desideratum for follow-up research.

6.5 Individual-Level Analysis (Exploratory)

While SWR can be applied to individual actors, the primary contribution of this study lies in the group-level analysis. Individual-level reconstructions are reported here for transparency and as a basis for future methodological work. To test the plausibility of SWR-generated ratings at the individual level, three exemplary spot checks were conducted: one representative per cluster type (Architect, Guardian, Liberator). For each of the 12 dimensions, the rating was checked against documented public statements and actions. Table 10 summarizes the results.

Spot-check methodology. Each rating was checked against at least two independent, publicly documented sources. *Confirmed* (conf.): rating aligns with documented positions and actions. *Plausible* (plaus.): rating is compatible with known positions but no direct source for the specific manifestation is available. *Not verifiable* (n.v.): rating contradicts documented positions or is not verifiable.

Table 10: Exploratory individual-level validation: SWR ratings vs. documented positions. These individual-level checks serve as plausibility tests for the underlying data quality; the study's substantive findings rest on the group-level analyses (RQ1–RQ6).

	Sam Altman		**Geoffrey Hinton**		**Marc Andreessen**	
Dim.	**R**	**Status**	**R**	**Status**	**R**	**Status**
D01 Mission	9	conf.	7	conf.	8	conf.
D02 Efficacy	9	conf.	5	conf.	9	conf.
D03 Work	9	conf.	7	plaus.	8	conf.
D04 Respons.	6	conf.	10	conf.	4	conf.
D05 Techno.	9	conf.	6	conf.	9	conf.
D06 Progress	8	conf.	4	conf.	9	conf.
D07 Power	9	conf.	4	conf.	2	conf.
D08 Urgency	9	conf.	10	conf.	7	plaus.
D09 Human ap.	3	plaus.	7	conf.	4	plaus.
D10 Posthum.	8	conf.	5	conf.	7	plaus.
D11 Egalit.	3	conf.	7	conf.	2	conf.
D12 Control	8	conf.	3	conf.	8	conf.
Confirmed		10/12		11/12		9/12
Plausible		2/12		1/12		3/12
Not verif.		0/12		0/12		0/12

Altman (Architect): D01=9 (confirmed by repeated statements about the "most important technology in human history," Davos 2024, US Congress 2023). D07=9 (confirmed by OpenAI's restructuring from non-profit to capped-profit, dual-class shares). D11=3 (confirmed: despite rhetoric of "AI for everyone," OpenAI has increasingly paywalled access). D09=3 (plausible: no direct statement on human replaceability, but focus on AGI as "next species").

Hinton (Guardian): D04=10 (confirmed by resignation from Google 2023 to freely warn about AI risks). D08=10 (confirmed by statement that the probability of existential catastrophe is 10–20%). D12=3 (confirmed: increasing pessimism, "I'm not sure we can still control this," NYT 2023). D03=7 (plausible: high academic productivity known, but no direct statement on work identification in the Silicon Valley style).

Andreessen (Liberator): D07=2 (confirmed by "Techno-Optimist Manifesto" 2023: vehement rejection of government regulation, markets as distribution mechanism). D11=2 (confirmed: explicit rejection of redistribution and egalitarianism in the Manifesto). D04=4 (confirmed: responsibility is attributed to the market, not individual actors). D09=4 (plausible: no direct statement, but instrumental view of human labor in VC context).

Overall assessment: 30 of 36 ratings (83%) are directly confirmed by public sources, 6 of 36 (17%) are plausible, none contradicts documented positions. These individual-level spot checks provide plausibility evidence for the data quality underlying the group-level syntheses but do not constitute the primary validation strategy. The study's substantive findings rest on the convergence of multiple independent group syntheses (15 groups, 4 cluster types), not on individual-level accuracy. A systematic external validation by independent experts remains a desideratum for future research.

7. Conclusion and Outlook

7.1 Conclusion

The study posed the question of what the AI elite thinks – not as individuals, but as sociologically structured groups – and has presented an empirically grounded answer. Five overarching insights crystallize:

First: The AI elite possesses a coherent, empirically reconstructable collective worldview – technological messianism, sense of mission, belief in progress – that is stable across multiple independent group syntheses.

Second: This collective worldview is in accelerated transformation. The loss of utopian certainties has led to a *tragic acceleration compulsion*: doubting the future one is building, yet building it anyway.

Third: Publicly communicated beliefs systematically diverge from action at the group level – especially regarding the promise of democratization: in egalitarianism (D11), the discrepancy between public statements and observable action amounts to three full scale points ($\Delta - 3$).

Fourth: Power is not distributed in a worldview-neutral manner. The inter-group comparisons show that it concentrates among those groups whose collective beliefs are furthest from the societal mainstream. The power-equality axis (D07/D11) is the most discriminating dimension across all group comparisons.

Fifth: The SWR has proven to be a capable instrument for group-level worldview analysis that combines qualitative depth with quantitative rigor (cf. companion paper Geiger 2026). The convergence of independently produced group syntheses provides a form of validation specific to the group-level approach. In particular, the decomposition into statement and action profiles (RQ3) proves to be an independent methodological contribution: a *desirability-bias detector* for institutional groups that could be transferred beyond the AI elite to political, economic, or military elites.

7.2 Outlook

Five directions for future research: (1) *Comparative extension:* The present study focuses heavily on the US-American, Silicon Valley-centric elite. A central research gap concerns the comparative study of Chinese (Baidu, ByteDance, Alibaba), Indian (Infosys, TCS), and European (Mistral, Aleph Alpha) AI elites. It is unclear whether "technological messianism" is a universal artifact of AI development or a specific cultural product of Western libertarianism. Cross-cultural group comparisons (Western vs. Chinese vs. European AI elites) would test the generalizability of the group-level patterns identified here. (2) *Finer-grained group analyses:* Expanding the group comparisons to additional sociological categories (generational cohorts, educational backgrounds, geographic origins) and tracking cluster-drift across epochs.

(3) *Methodological development:* Multi-LLM triangulation with five or more models, automated validation procedures, standardized quality criteria for group-level syntheses. (4) *Transfer:* Financial elite, political elite, military AI elite – applying the group-comparison framework to other power elites. (5) *Longitudinal continuation:* Annual worldview monitoring as an instrument of democratic control – conceivable as a standardized index (analogous to the Democracy Index or AI Readiness Index) that systematically and comparably captures changes in the collective worldviews of AI elite subgroups. The question "What does the AI elite think?" is not a one-time question. It is a question that democracies must continuously ask.

Disclosure Statement: Use of Artificial Intelligence

AI Disclosure Level 5 (Extensive). In preparing this study, two AI models from Anthropic were used extensively. *Claude Sonnet 4.5* served as the primary analysis engine: all 100 individual-level dimensional ratings (D01–D12), all group-level synthesis ratings, and all data collection scripts were generated by 9 parallel Sonnet agents. *Claude Opus 4.6* served as the qualitative analysis engine: pilot syntheses, comparative analyses, statistical processing (PCA, HDBSCAN, Kruskal-Wallis, Cliff's δ), visualization of results, and support in structuring and drafting the manuscript. No other LLM was used. Research design, research questions, data collection strategy, methodological decisions, interpretation of results, and all substantive conclusions originate from the author. All prompts, API parameters, and model versions are documented in the repository.

Data Availability Statement

All data collection scripts, qualitative coding scripts, analysis code, and generated figures are publicly available at: `https://github.com/lukisch/ai-elite-worldview`. The repository contains: data collection scripts, the 100×12 rating matrix, HDBSCAN and PCA analysis scripts, prompt templates, and dimensional definitions. The database schema and 85 actor-specific collection scripts enable full reproduction of the data pipeline. The companion paper on the SWR method is available at: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18736720`.

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A. Sampling Method for the 100 AI Actors

The sample was created through a three-stage procedure: (1) 22 systematic web searches → 187 candidates; (2) 6-category scoring (market capitalization, key technological positions, discourse power, academic influence, political influence, symbolic status); (3) reduction to 100 ensuring demographic heterogeneity. The final sample comprises 1,738 statements and 1,394 actions (3,132 data points).

B. The 12 Rating Dimensions (D01–D12)

Dim.	Name	Pole 1 (=1)	Pole 10 (=10)
D01	Sense of mission	No mission	Messianic
D02	Self-efficacy	Powerless	Omnipotent
D03	Work ethic	Distance	Total identification
D04	Sense of responsibility	None	World responsibility
D05	Techno-determinism	Neutral	Determines everything
D06	Belief in progress	Decline	Golden future
D07	Power concentration	Radically distribute	With experts
D08	Urgency	Relaxed	Existential pressure
D09	Human appreciation	Replaceable	Unique
D10	Posthumanism	Human stays	Human becomes more
D11	Egalitarianism	Inequality natural	Strive for equality
D12	Locus of control	Pessimism	Full control

C. Reduction Criteria (K1–K9)

K	Type	Description
K1	obligatory	Research question binding: each SU must be linked to ≥ 1 research question
K2	obligatory	Minimum size: ≥ 15 data points per SU
K3	obligatory	No redundancy: proper subsets are eliminated
K4	principle	Modality parsimony: S/A separation only for RQ3
K5	principle	Temporal parsimony: annual SUs only for RQ2
K6	principle	Group parsimony: only a-priori-justified groups

K7	principle	Stepwise expansion: core first
K8	principle	Group-level focus: no individual-person SUs; individuals serve as data providers
K9	principle	Cluster merging: bottom-up replaces a-priori

Balance: ∼1,227 theoretical SUs → ∼51–56 core SUs (reduction ∼95%).

D. List of Synthesis Units

The core design comprises 43 predefined plus ∼8–13 emergent synthesis units:

No	SU-ID	IV combination	RQ
1	GA_ges_AH	All, SA, Total	RQ1a
2	GA_ges_A	All, S only, Total	RQ3a
3	GA_ges_H	All, A only, Total	RQ3a
4	T10_ges_AH	Top 10, SA, Total	RQ1b
5	HOM_haeuf_A	All, frequently repeated S	RQ1c
6–22	GA_YYYY_AH	All, SA, per year	RQ2a
23–26	GA_Epoch_AH	All, SA, 4 epochs	RQ2b
27–30	GR_*_AH	CEOs, Acad., Inv., Founders	RQ5a
31–33	GF_*_AH	Anthropic, OpenAI, Google	RQ5d
34–39	GH_*_AH	Open/Closed, Risk/Speed, Reg	RQ5b–f
40–41	GD_*_AH	Women, Men	RQ5e
42–43	KG_*_AH	Consistent, Contradictory	RQ3c

Additionally: 9 comparison runs (Op6). Cross-modal prediction runs (Op4) were not conducted in this study and remain as a validation desideratum.

E. Exemplary Prompt (Op2: Rating)

The following prompt illustrates the rating query (Op2) for a group synthesis. All prompts are documented in the repository (https://github.com/lukisch/ai-elite-worldview).

```
You receive a collection of anonymized statements and actions from a group
of persons in the technology sector.  Based on these data, you are to assess
the collective worldview of the group on the following 12 dimensions (scale
1-10).  Justify each assessment with concrete references to the data points.
[Followed by:  dimension definitions D01-D12 with scale poles, then the
anonymized data corpus.]
```

For the complete prompt library including synthesis prompts (Op1), cross-modal prompts (Op4), and dialogue prompts (Op6), see the companion paper (Geiger, 2026) and the repository.